ST MARY'S DSG, KLOOF

GRADE 10 **JANUARY 2026**

ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE:
CYCLE TEST: COMPREHENSION & LANGUAGE

TIME: 55min + 5min READING **TOTAL: 30 MARKS**

QUESTION 1 COMPREHENSION

Refer to **TEXT 1** (*World in Paradox: Hate Speech vs. Speech Freedom*, by Milton Wolf), as well as **TEXT 1A** and **TEXT 1B** on the Insert, and answer the questions below.

1.1 Consider Paragraph 2

1.1.1 Using your understanding, or by inferring from context, provide a definition for the word "paradox". Your definition should state the part of speech, as well as show your understanding of the term. (2)

1.1.2 Identify one paradox mentioned in this paragraph. (1)

1.2 Consider Paragraph 4

1.2.1 Simplify the following extract by re-writing it in your own words to show your understanding: 'hate speech is only one side of the iceberg, and doesn't capture the range of propaganda methods used by intolerant groups.' (2)

1.2.2 Provide a synonym for the word 'synthetic' in the context of the passage. (1)

1.2.3 According to George C, what is the difference between **hate speech** and **hate spin**? (2)

1.3 Consider Paragraph 5

Is the internet to blame for the use of hate speech? Provide evidence from the passage to support your answer. (3)

1.4 Consider Paragraph 6

1.4.1 "hate speech requires special handling, particularly when it targets minorities unable to counter it.'
Explain why minorities are particularly vulnerable to hate speech and, using your own knowledge, describe two possible consequences they might face as a result. (3)

1.4.2 Explain the difference between 'prohibition' and 'censorship' in the context of this passage. (3)

1.5 Consider Paragraphs 7 and 8

In *your opinion*, do you believe modern journalism has been successful in '[forcing] us to actively confront problems that affect us all' in an ethical way? Provide an example of one issue that you have been confronted with as evidence. (3)

1.6 Consider **TEXT 1**, as well as the images **TEXT 1A** and **TEXT 1B.**

Which image better captures the opinion of the writer in **TEXT 1**? Your answer should provide visual and verbal details from both images, as well as evidence from the text to support your answer. (5)

[25]

QUESTION 2 LANGUAGE AND TEXTUAL EDITING

Refer to **TEXT 2** and answer the questions that follow.

2.1 Refer to the following:

PARAGRAPH 1: "What Country is This?" PARAGRAPH 6: "We are already experiencing the effects…"

Explain whether the use of the inverted commas used in paragraph 1 and paragraph 6 is the same. (2)

2.2 Identify and correct the spelling error in paragraph 2. (1)

2.3 Refer to the following from paragraph 3:

"the campaign spotlights regions deeply scarred by climate disruption**:**[1] drought**-**[2]stricken Gilbués"

Identify, and give the function of, both punctuation marks used in the above extract. (2)

[5]

TOTAL: 30 MARKS

[1] Punctuation mark #1
[2] Punctuation mark #2

TEXT 1

World in Paradox: Hate Speech vs. Speech Freedom

By Milton Wolf
2023

1 In the past few years, we have experienced problems like Covid-19 pandemic, climate change, chaos in global politics, war, terrorism, tensions between digitalized life and loss of privacy, capitalism versus working-class struggles, as well as the monopoly by Internet giants which penetrated every aspect of our life and, unfortunately, we cannot see an end to any of these shadows in the coming years.

2 Our world is in a paradox: the tension between hatred and harmony as we see the rise of hate speech, populism, and identity politics. The paradox also refers to conflicts between human and nature - environmentalists versus anti-environmentalists - and it highlights the tension between the local and the global.

3 In this paradoxical world, hate speech has become common on the Internet. Law scholars observe that the wide-spread hate speech on social media is the "generic term that has come to embrace the use of speech attacks based on race, ethnicity, religion and sexual orientation or preference." Social media therefore faces the problem of identifying and censoring problematic posts while weighing the right to freedom of speech.

4 George C. (2017) thinks that hate speech is only one side of the iceberg, and doesn't capture the range of propaganda methods used by intolerant groups. He developed the concept of "hate spin" to expose the dirty political practice of using religious issues in discourse. If we think of hate speech as the *giving* of harmful offense, then this form of **synthetic** anger amounts to strategic *offense-taking*. For example, Trump supporters *give offense* using hate speech saying that America should build the wall to defend the country against Muslims. At the same time, politicians may use an Islamic figure to *take offense* in order to gain public support.

5 Conventional hate speech is certainly ancient: historians show how it facilitated crimes such as the dehumanizing discourse around slavery or the massacre of indigenous populations by colonists. The Internet has made things easier for hate-spin agents, but it is not indispensable. Hate spin campaigns also spread by satellite television, political rallies, places of worship, and word of mouth. Religious hate spin is especially potent and is often used as a political weapon; religious extremists become convenient tools to silence controversial movements.

6 How to rescue democracy from hate spin is hotly debated. Although there is a dilemma between free speech and hate speech, even free-speech advocates agree that hate speech requires special handling, particularly when it targets minorities unable to counter it. When comment incites violence, prohibition may be required. George proposes that law, politicians, civil society and media all play big roles: hate speech may require public intervention, including, in some circumstances, legal prohibition, but must not censor expressions that only offend people's feelings, even if they insult deeply held beliefs.

7 The Ethical Journalism Network launched the "Turning the Page of Hate" campaign in 2014. It is a test they developed, based on international standards, that highlights questions in the gathering, preparation and dissemination of news to help place what is said, and who is saying

it, in an ethical context:

1. STATUS OF THE SPEAKER: How might their position influence their motives?

2. REACH OF THE SPEECH: How far is the speech traveling?

3. GOALS OF THE SPEECH: How does it benefit the speaker and their interests? Is it deliberately intended to cause harm to others?

4. THE CONTENT ITSELF: Is the speech dangerous? Could it incite violence towards others?

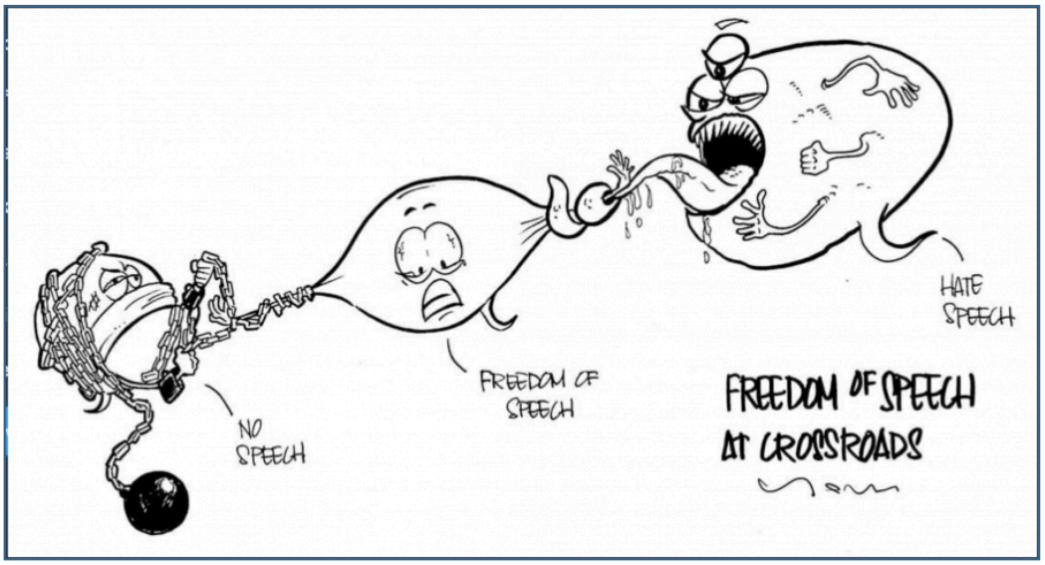
5. SURROUNDING CLIMATE – SOCIAL / ECONOMIC / POLITICAL:Who might be negatively affected? Is there a history of conflict or discrimination?

Don't sensationalise! Take time to reflect and avoid rushing to publish.

8 Such journalistic intervention requires comparative, historical thinking - considering history, culture, religion and politics - because in an era of human-induced war, global environmental change, and unprecedented flows of media and knowledge, the world in paradox forces us to actively confront problems that affect us all, even when they seem far from our own lives.

https://www.un.org/en/hate-speech/understanding-hate-speech/hate-speech-versus-freedom-of-speech

TEXT 1A



TEXT 1B



TEXT 2



Greenpeace unveils a shocking campaign that feels like it's from another planet

1 With stunning visuals of the Amazon and other regions hard-hit by the environmental crisis, Greenpeace Brazil launches a striking new campaign dubbed "What Country is This?"

2 An initiative that blends visual art, documentary storytelling, and political urgancy to raise awareness about a crisis that is no longer distant — but already unfolding before our eyes.

3 Created by the Brazilian-creative agency Beta Collective in collaboration with I.M (Irmãos Meirelles), the campaign spotlights regions deeply scarred by climate disruption: drought-stricken Gilbués (Piauí), collapsing river systems like the Coari, and scorched forests around Tefé and Porto Velho. Once familiar names to Brazilians, these places are now transformed into desolate scenes worthy of a post-apocalyptic film.

4 But this is no fiction. These landscapes have truly changed. The ground is cracked, forests have burned, rivers have dried up. Greenpeace's goal is clear: to powerfully convey the violent reality of climate change through raw, compellingly documented images — captured in a visual style that evokes space photography from Mars or Venus.

5 No AI. No Hollywood-style special effects. The images in this campaign - though surreal at times - are authentic aerial photographs taken across Brazilian territory. It's this very tension, between stark realism and otherworldly aesthetics, that gives the campaign its striking impact.

6 As Laura Leal, Director of Engagement at Greenpeace Brazil, puts it: "We are already experiencing the effects of the climate crisis. But there is still time to act."

[Image & Text Source:<https://www.adsoftheworld.com/campaigns/what-planet-is-this>]

MARKER 1 (8)

1.1 1.1.1	Consider Paragraph 2 Using your understanding, or by inferring from context, provide a definition for the word "paradox". Your definition should state the part of speech, as well as show your understanding of the term.	(2)
	Paradox (noun) ✔- a statement, idea, or situation that **appears to be contradictory**, ✔ illogical, or impossible, yet may contain a deeper truth or be true in some unexpected way. It often involves two opposing concepts or facts existing at the same time,✔ challenging conventional thinking and inviting deeper reflection	
1.1.2	State one paradox mentioned in this paragraph.	(1)
	Hatred & Harmony / Human & Nature / Local & Global	
1.2 1.2.1	Consider Paragraph 4 Simplify the following extract by re-writing it in your own words to show your understanding: 'hate speech is only one side of the iceberg, and doesn't capture the range of propaganda methods used by intolerant groups.'	(2)
	Hate speech doesn't cover all of the many ways ✔people express their intolerance/ prejudicial✔ views. Hate speech is just one of many tactics✔ that people use to show their prejudices.✔ 1 mark for understanding that it's just one of the tactics 1 mark for showing understanding of 'intolerant groups'	
1.2.2	Provide a synonym for the word 'synthetic' in the context of the passage.	(1)
	Fake /artificial /phony / pretend / counterfeit	
1.2.3	According to George C, what is the difference between **hate speech** and **hate spin**?	(2)
	Hate *speech* is the giving of offense✔ through slurs and discriminatory language ✔ whereas hate *spin* refers to the taking of offense✔ and turning it back on the offender in order to further a political agenda by highlighting the other side and emphasising their prejudice.✔	

MARKER 2 (8)		
1.3 1.3.1	Consider Paragraph 5 Is the internet to blame for the use of hate speech? Provide evidence from the passage to support your answer.	(3)
	1. Yes: The internet has made hate speech more common and not only allows for it to reach a wider audience✔ but also makes contributing to the problem easier by giving people easy access to multiple online platforms✔, so 'The Internet has made things easier for hate-spin agents'.✔ 2. No: Hate speech has been around since before the internet and 'is certainly ancient'. ✔ There are many examples of hate speech occurring long before the internet,✔ such as, 'the dehumanizing discourse around slavery'. Hate speech can also be shared 'by satellite television, political rallies, places of worship' and therefore does not require the internet.✔	
1.4 1.4.1	Consider Paragraph 6 "Hate speech requires special handling, particularly when it targets minorities unable to counter it.' Explain why minorities are particularly vulnerable to hate speech and, using your own knowledge, describe two possible consequences they might face as a result.	(3)
	Minorities are particularly vulnerable to hate speech because they often have less social, political, and economic power than dominant groups. This makes it harder to defend themselves✔ If it spreads unchecked, it can escalate to violence,✔ which would be one consequence, another consequence would be that they are excluded or discriminated against because they have less influence to fight it ✔	
LANGUAGE Refer to **TEXT 2** and answer the questions that follow.		
2.1	**PARAGRAPH 1:** "What Country is This?" **PARAGRAPH 6:** "We are already experiencing the effects…" Explain whether the use of the inverted commas used in **paragraph 1** and **paragraph 6** is the same.	(2)
	paragraph 1, the inverted commas indicated a title. In paragraph 6, the inverted commas indicate a quotation/direct speech.	

MARKER 3 (7)

1.4.2	Explain the difference between 'prohibition' and 'censorship' in the context of this passage.	(3)
	To prohibit something means to not allow it all (1), whereas to censor something means it is allowed, but there are restrictions placed on it (1). The passage explains that speech that violates another person's rights or is harmful to them should have legal consequences and therefore be prohibited, whereas speech that offends others or shows controversial views should be more carefully censored on public platforms (eg: trigger warnings or age limits), but not made illegal. (1)	
1.5 1.5.1	Consider Paragraphs 7 and 8 In *your opinion*, do you believe modern journalism has been successful in '[forcing] us to actively confront problems that affect us all' in an ethical way? Provide an example of one issue that you have been confronted with as evidence.	(3)
	Successful? (1) A problem that affects us all (1) Ethical? (1) Eg: Social media has allowed journalists to successfully present issues to a global audience, allowing for important issues to have more exposure by reaching a wider audience (1). Issues such as GBV affect everyone regardless of gender and journalists have forced us to confront our role in the issue (1). Modern journalism does, however, Face a lot of competition with other media outlets which often forces journalists to publish first without doing the proper reflection or ethical checks, which results in information being spread that is incorrect, biased or unethically presented (1)	
LANGUAGE Refer to **TEXT 2** and answer the questions that follow.		
2.2	Identify and correct the spelling error in **paragraph 2**.	
	urgancy should be urgency [½ identification and ½ correction]	(1)

MARKER 4 (7)

1.6 1.6.1	Consider TEXT 1, as well as the images TEXT 1A and TEXT 1B Which image better captures the opinion of the writer in TEXT 1? Your answer should provide visual and verbal details from both images, as well as evidence from the text to support your answer.	(5)
	Image 1: Discussion + Visual/verbal (2) Image 2: Discussion + Visual/verbal (2) Text: Writer's opinion + evidence (1) Eg: The writer of the article believes free speech should be protected, but makes a distinction between 'free' speech and 'hate' speech stating it as 'attacks based on race, ethnicity, religion and sexual orientation or preference'. They also state that, 'identifying and censoring problematic posts while weighing the right to freedom of speech' is a complicated issue. Image 1 shows free speech personified, with the verbal details indicating it is being torn between 'no speech' and 'hate speech', illustrating the two possible consequences of either allowing or censoring free speech. Therefore image 1 more accurately reflects the complicated issue of free speech, as Image B, set against the backdrop of the American flag, simply states that '[their] rights are more important than [our] feelings', which does not distinguish between hurt feelings and prejudicial statements, making it a less accurate reflection of the complexities associated with the issue of free speech.	
LANGUAGE Refer to **TEXT 2** and answer the questions that follow.		
2.3	Refer to the following from **paragraph 3:** "the campaign spotlights regions deeply scarred by climate disruption: drought-stricken Gilbués"	
	Identify and give the function of <u>both</u> punctuation marks used in the above extract.	
	Colon (½) to introduce the climate-stricken areas (½) Hyphen (½) to create the compound word "drought-stricken" (½)	(2)